

1. Quoting Sam Altman

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-20T03:47:59+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/20/sam-altman/#atom-everything>

We have been having extensive discussions around open source strategy. We will discuss it more at our next board meeting, but one thing we'd like to do soon is to create a language model with the approximate capability of GPT-3 that can run locally on consumer hardware and release that. We'd like to do it soon, before Stability or someone else does. In general, we think this helps discourage others from releasing similarly-powerful models, and makes it harder for new efforts to get funded. ? Sam Altman , Email to OpenAI's board, October 1, 2022 - exposed in Musk v. Altman (2026) Tags: ai-ethics , sam-altman , generative-ai , openai , ai , llms

2. AI Mania Is Eviscerating Global Decision-Making

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-19T05:06:21+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/19/ai-mania/#atom-everything>

AI Mania Is Eviscerating Global Decision-Making Here's an entertaining perspective from Nik Suresh on the AI mania that is overwhelming the large companies that he consults with. It's crammed with spicy anecdotes from anonymous sources. In one extreme case, I have seen an executive confess that they had never even used ChatGPT or any AI tool in their life, immediately after producing a technical strategy for an organisation with \$2B+ in revenue which was entirely centered around AI. Here's a report from an engineer at a company with a token leaderboard: Checking out a parallel copy of our Go repository and telling the AI to rewrite the whole thing in Zig while I work on something else just so I can keep my job. I particularly enjoyed this conversation with a skeptical executive at an over-enthusiastic company: I asked why this was being repeated without opposition. Was it just sales fluff? The answer was a lot more interesting. It was partially ridiculous sales material being delivered to an easily excitable audience, but this was not the dominant factor constraining honesty. Executives at their customers were saying absurd things about achieving 100x productivity, and this meant...

3. nascheme/quixote

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-18T05:27:49+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/18/quixote/#atom-everything>

nascheme/quixote A certain vintage if Python web nerd might be delighted to learn that the most recent commit to the Quixote web framework was six hours ago . The oldest commit in that repo is from 21 years ago, and that was the initial import of Quixote 2.4 from Subversion into Git.

Tags: computer-history , python , web-frameworks

4. Paper

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-19T22:31:11Z

Link: https://paper.design/?utm_source=df

My thanks to Paper for sponsoring last week at DF. Paper is a new professional design tool where every layer is real HTML and CSS. Your design is already code, which means fewer handoffs, translations, and layers of abstraction between what you design and what you actually ship. Paper works both ways: code to design, and design to code. Connect any AI agent through MCP and the agent can read and edit your designs. Or use Paper Snapshot to capture your live site as editable layers and make new iterations. Agents handle the tedious work so you can focus on your craft and the decisions that matter. Try Paper at paper.design (great domain name), and check out the documentation and FAQ for more info . ?

5. 9to5Mac Uncovers Dozens of Disguised Gambling Apps on the App Store in Brazil

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-19T17:18:57Z

Link: <https://9to5mac.com/2026/07/17/investigation-reveals-dozens-of-disguised-gambling-apps-on-the-app-store-in-brazil/>

9to5Mac: Brazilian users browsing the App Store rankings in categories such as Navigation, Travel, and Weather have noticed a growing number of poorly made games appearing among the top results, many of them featuring AI-generated illustrations of animals as their app icons. As it turns out, these are so-called jacket apps, which are just a front for hidden betting and gambling apps. A 9to5Mac investigation has uncovered more than 60 apps that behave exactly as depicted in their App Store screenshots when accessed from virtually anywhere in the world, except Brazil. When opened from a Brazilian IP address, the same apps instead reveal online betting platforms, as shown in the example below, which is currently the top app in the Weather category. Obviously the main problem is that these apps disguise themselves Trojan Horse-style, and slip through App Store review undetected. I don't think it's reasonable to think App Store review could catch every attempt at this sort of thing though ? if the horses are disguised well-enough, some of them are going to slip through. That's actually fine. But the first example 9to5Mac cites isn't well disguised at all. What sense does it make that ?...

6. OpenAI's Product Shake-Up Put the Complexifiers in Charge

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-17T20:27:53Z

Link: <https://www.wired.com/story/openai-reorg-greg-brockman-product/>

Wired, back on May 15: OpenAI says it's folding ChatGPT, its AI coding agent Codex, and its developer-facing API into one core product team. The company says that Codex is increasingly powering its consumer and enterprise offerings, which are gaining the ability to perform digital tasks autonomously on behalf of users. Other OpenAI leaders are also taking on larger roles at the company as part of the changes. OpenAI's head of Codex, Thibault Sottiaux, has been tapped to lead the company's core product and platform teams. Sottiaux was a key leader in building Codex into one of the company's fastest-growing products of all time. He's also one of the leaders overseeing development of OpenAI's forthcoming "super app," which aims to combine Codex, ChatGPT, and the company's Atlas web browser into a unified desktop application. I'll give them credit for sticking with a plan for two whole months to get this out the door. But the problem is they went the wrong way. Instead of putting the eggheads from Codex in charge of ChatGPT, they should have put the product-minded people from ChatGPT in charge of Codex. Codex, I'm finally learning, is sprawling and confusing. It needs a strong dose of...

7. Fitting a regular expression to a list of words

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 19 Jul 2026 19:30:17 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/07/19/fitting-a-regex/>

Suppose you want to search for a list of words. If you're using grep, you can add the -f flag provide a file of regular expressions, and you can add the -F to tell it that the regular expressions are in fact just words. I did something like this a couple days ago when searching [?] The post Fitting a regular expression to a list of words first appeared on John D. Cook .

8. Sum of low squares

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 19 Jul 2026 16:41:48 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/07/19/sum-of-low-squares/>

Squares, high and low Let p be an odd prime number. Then half the numbers from 1 through $p-1$ are squares and half are not. That is, for half of numbers $1 \leq k < p$ The post Sum of low squares first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. email encryption

Source: computers are bad | Published: 19 Jul 2026 00:00:00 UT

Link: <https://computer.rip/2026-07-19-email-encryption.html>

Email, one of the most pervasive and enduring technologies of computer networking, was invented in about a dozen places by dozens of people in the 1960s. It's hard to lay out a clear history of the technology because it's just so obvious?pretty much as soon as more than one person could use a computer, there was some kind of mail facility. These ranged from mainframe-centric systems where all of the users of a single computer could write messages to each other, to PC-centric systems where workstations would mount a network share to store and retrieve

messages. Pretty much any scheme you can come up with for moving messages was probably in use somewhere from roughly the 1960s to the 1990s, by which time the ARPANET-derived family of email implementations had taken hold. This form of email has a clearer heritage, to Ray Tomlinson, who came up with the core idea that addresses could identify both a user and a host, and that some kind of open protocol could be used to send messages to another host when necessary. Over time, and with many revisions, Tomlinson's design became SMTP and was joined by protocols like IMAP that built out the form of email we use today. This is a form of email...